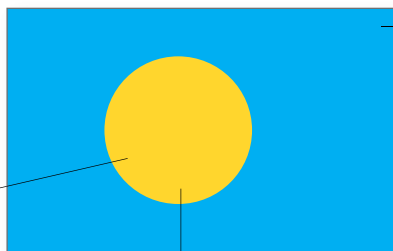


Palau

Ratio: 5:8 **Adopted:** January 1, 1981 **Usage:** National and Civil

The golden disc depicts the full moon, considered by Palauans to be the best time for celebrations and harvesting



Blue symbolizes the freedom of self-rule

The full moon is set slightly toward the hoist

Australasia and Oceania



Under US control since 1945, **Palau** became a republic in 1981. In 1994, it became independent in association with the United States.

The current flag was introduced in 1981 when Palau became a republic. Previously, the flag of the Trust Territory of the Pacific Islands was flown jointly with the United Nations and United States flags.

THE SYMBOLISM OF THE FLAG

The flag's very simple design belies the depth of meaning attributed to it. The explanation for the choice of colors is rooted in the history and customs of the Palauan people. The bright blue of the field, which might be assumed to be symbolic of the Pacific Ocean, is in fact a representation of the transition from foreign domination to self-government. The golden disc, which

sits slightly off center toward the hoist, represents the full moon. The Palauans consider the full moon to be the optimum time for human activity. This time of the month when celebrations, harvesting and planting, fishing, tree-felling, and the carving of traditional canoes are carried out. The moon is a symbol of peace, love and tranquility.

THE SEAL OF PALAU

Palau does not have a coat of arms, but has a seal, adopted in 1981, when the country became a republic. The seal is not colored. It depicts a traditional Palauan triangular hut, above the date of adoption. This is surrounded by the title of the state.